



the sum
together we are greater

The Power of Difference Model (PDM)

What is the PDM?

- The PDM identifies 3 primary patterns of behavior, thought, feeling, worldview and/or orientation related to race, sexual orientation, gender, socio-economic class, religion, disability, and culture.
- These patterns operate unconsciously within us, between us, in our communities, organizations, and world.
- Our primary patterns come from early childhood learning about what will keep us safe.
- To the degree we are unaware of these patterns, we can experience internal conflict and conflict with others who hold different primary patterns and across differences in general.

The Three Primary Patterns

SENSITIVITY - "SCARECROW"

- Understanding
- Truth
- Brain
- Magician



I value differences, open-mindedness, and understanding. I experience the world and myself mostly through the brain. I treat others the way *they* would like to be treated. Limitations: I don't want to offend so I can feel stuck or confused. I can be patronizing as I try to get others to "get it", to "understand like me." I can also feel exhausted as this struggle can seem endless.

Fear response: freeze
Politics: tends liberal
Archetype: Magician

ONENESS – "TINMAN"

- Unity
- Connection
- Heart
- Lover



I devalue differences in favor of our common humanity, unity, and collaboration. I experience the world and myself primarily through the heart. I treat others the way I would like to be treated. I try to build bridges. Limitations: I can over-value sameness and fail to impact in alignment with my intentions. I can avoid conflict.

Fear response: flight
Politics: tends moderate
Archetype: Lover

STRENGTH - "LION"

- Courage
- Power
- Gut
- Warrior

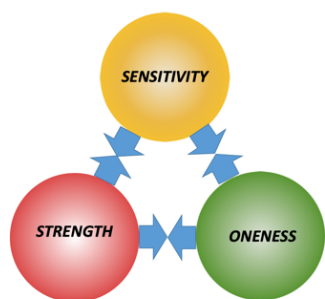


I evaluate differences and value courage, loyalty, decisiveness, clarity, protection, self-sacrifice, and winning at all cost. I believe in the "Survival of the fittest." I experience myself and the world primarily through my gut. Limitations: I can seek dominance over others and can create enemies.

Fear response: fight
Politics: tends conservative
Archetype: Warrior

Appreciation is a fourth pattern that is a mirror-image of Strength. In this pattern I *positively* evaluate, stereotype, or romanticize a particular group of which I'm not a member (could be a religion, culture, class, gender, sexual orientation, disability, or racial group). In Strength, I evaluate another group as "*less than*" and in the Appreciation pattern I evaluate another group as "*better than*".

Learn more about the PDM by [CLICKING HERE](#). To learn about the Power of Difference Assessment (PDA): [CLICK HERE](#).



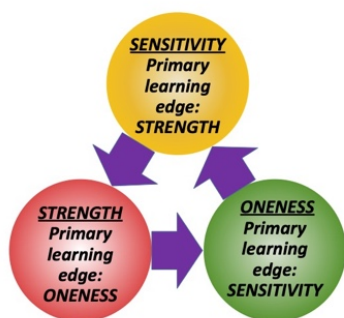
Conflict Within and THEN Without

Each pattern conflicts with the other two. This conflict occurs within us first, in our childhood, as we attempt to minimize the parts of ourselves and strategies that seem less safe in favor of the parts of ourselves and strategies that feel safer. From here, we enter the world and are drawn to others like us while conflicting with those with a different primary pattern. In this way we create together, a dynamic and systems that represent a kind of *dysfunctional balance*...first within each of us and from there, in our families, organizations, communities, and world.

Integration/Leveraging

The more we come to know our primary pattern (its assets *and* liabilities) and how to integrate or leverage the assets of the all three patterns, the more we unleash our effectiveness: always within us first. From here, we increasingly become a catalyst for solidarity and meaningful change across differences in our family, organization, community, and world.

Archetypally, this aware, integrated self is called the “Sovereign”. In the Wizard of Oz this archetype is Glinda the Good Witch and it’s often represented as a halo or crown at the top of the head in art and literature. Another way to conceptualize Integration/Leveraging is as a captain who recognizes the important role in the person who navigates (the guiding force), the person who steers (the directional force), and the person who runs the sails (the driving force). The captain is able to coordinate these aspects so that they function in alignment with one another rather than in conflict.



Your Learning Edge

The key to integration or leveraging lies in your learning edge. For those in Sensitivity, your primary learning edge is *Strength*...moving beyond confusion and politeness to “power up” *but with compassion*. For those in Strength, it is *Oneness* and the realization we are one human family. For those in Oneness, it is *Sensitivity*, requiring us to see how we protect ourselves by over-valuing sameness and how we impact others in ways we don’t intend.

The Power of Difference Assessment (PDA)

The PDA, developed by The Sum, is a ground-breaking, highly reliable and valid measurement these unconscious patterns (as determined by a team from North Carolina State University). The Sum has found that, as people integrate these assets and minimize the liabilities, they report greater:

1. effectiveness and sense of solidarity across differences
2. flexibility to utilize assets from any or all of the patterns as needed
3. recognition of one's own privilege and how to use it effectively
4. impact across differences generally as intended
5. pride without prejudice
6. ability to choose a path that “refuses” silence and violence
7. ability, clarity, & courage to withdraw participation in violent aspects of systems
8. capacity to catalyze meaningful systemic change *without effort*
9. internal stability...less rising and falling on external conditions
10. clarity, empowerment, purpose, & fulfillment
11. ability to hold self and others accountable to increased internal integration w/o blame or shame